

Evgenii Zaitsev

Product Manager · B2B and B2C

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Saint Petersburg · Russian / English · Technical background

PMP (PMI, 2023) · Certified ScrumMaster (CSM, 2023) · HSE: Master in Management, professional education with distinction

Product Manager with an engineering background and B2B/B2C experience. I connect research, strategy and teamwork. EmTalk founder, from customer discovery to released apps. Team results: LTV +20% at Kickidler; time-to-market from 1.5 months to 2 weeks at Samolet. Metrics are provided by the author.

Experience & responsibility

Samolet | Apr 2026 - present

Product Manager · Internal CRM products

Work on sales CRM conversion; forecast economic impact of the initiatives: approximately RUB 500 million. With the team, reduced TTM from 1.5 months to 2 weeks and defect leakage from ~30% to 11%. Built a Python/Streamlit and ClickHouse analytics product.

- Used customer discovery and stakeholder conversations to identify blockers in sales workflows and prioritise fixes.

EmTalk | Feb 2023 - present

Founder / Product Owner

50+ customer discovery interviews; built a team without initial funding. Released BRET and Decision Matrix with AI alternatives on Google Play. Developing the AI direction: team n8n and RAG tools for articles and courses.

- Responsible for product strategy, development and first users; lead discovery, roadmap and prioritization.

Freelance / Project engagements | Jun 2023 - Apr 2026

Project / Product Manager

Kickidler: LTV grew by 20%, TTM halved (self-reported); diagnosis, roadmap and analytics. WinLab: Senior Project Manager (outstaff), assortment, checkout and 1C reporting.

- WinLab: with the team, moved the assortment project to business and functional requirements; secured contractor priority for the checkout project. 1C reporting reached a test launch before I left.

Statistics & Control / Statcontrol | Jul 2019 - Feb 2023

Technical Product Owner / Project Manager

Managed projects with a combined value of approximately RUB 50 million per year. OptiRamp: discovery and digital twins. Honeywell DCS: migration automation in a four-person team.

- Worked with Russian and international clients from presales and problem discovery through OptiRamp implementation and testing.

Gazprom avtomatizatsia | Oct 2017 - Jul 2019

Team Leader

Control systems for gas turbines and gas transport facilities. Engineering and on-site team leadership, including assignments beyond the Arctic Circle.

- Developed control software; contributed to commissioning, FAT and SAT.

Product stories

Samolet: from user friction to faster delivery

Two CRM products, a newly assembled team and low adoption. I started with discovery and priority fixes, then changed requirements, early QA involvement and analytics.

Context and priorities

I joined a newly assembled team in April 2026. Sales users often chose other tools. Through customer discovery and conversations with sales managers and regional leads, I identified workflow blockers and prioritised fixes. I work on conversion; the initiatives have a forecast economic impact of approximately RUB 500 million. This is a forecast, not realised income.

Discovery and delivery decisions

I designed an ICONIX-based approach to requirements using user flows, use cases and PlantUML sequence diagrams, reviewed before development. We involved QA earlier and introduced human-reviewed AI-generated test cases, automation and SDD.

How a data gap led to a new product

The team needed data to make decisions, but had no product analyst, and preparing reports was difficult. With AI assistance, I built an analytics product in Python and Streamlit to create dashboards and analyse ClickHouse data. When a product analyst joined, they adopted the approach. The product remains in use and has become essential to analytics for internal products.

Team results

We reduced time-to-market from 1.5 months to two weeks and defect leakage from ~30% to 11%. My contribution covered priorities, requirements, early QA involvement and stakeholder collaboration. These were shared results of process changes, not the effect of a single tool.

Work still in progress

Adoption remains a challenge: product metrics have started to improve but are still weak. We continue root-cause analysis and work on workflows and usage habits. Faster delivery alone does not establish product success.

[Read the case online](#)

EmTalk: from research to two apps

I build a project focused on mental well-being and decision-making. Together with the team, we moved from customer discovery to BRET, Decision Matrix and a content website.

Starting point

During research, conducted more than 50 customer discovery interviews and studied the market and competitors. Built a part-time team without an initial budget to explore useful well-being and decision-making scenarios.

My role and actions

Founder and product lead: strategy, market and competitor research, requirements, backlog, prioritisation and team coordination. I prepared the pitch deck, investor materials and a go-to-market plan.

From research to release

Together with the team, brought BRET and Decision Matrix to publication on Google Play. The EmTalk website offers five tests and nine articles, including an article with an audio version.

The products

BRET brings together well-being practices. Decision Matrix helps compare options: its official listing describes categories, Pros & Cons, decision history and AI suggestions for alternatives.

AI tools

Developing the EmTalk AI direction: n8n and hybrid RAG for articles and courses, with separate generation and validation stages. The website examines team tool configurations; their existence does not establish measured impact.

[Read the case online](#)

Systems, teams & approach

WinLab: complex projects and stakeholder management

Flexible assortment matrix

The project aimed to expand regional assortments through local producers and create an opportunity for revenue growth. Discussions with the main stakeholder were tense. I temporarily paused direct communication with them, involved a wider group of stakeholders and heard other perspectives. We then brought leadership into the work. Together with the team, we moved the project to preparing business and functional requirements.

Checkout system and Kafka

Another project involved moving the checkout system from a monolith to microservices and Kafka. My task was to secure priority with contractor Kristall and keep the project on schedule. I challenged their project managers' position using project management practices and set out my next steps. Within a few hours, they accepted my position; the contractor prioritised the project.

1C reporting automation

The main challenge here was working with the business stakeholder. During one project meeting, the accounting team broke off the discussion and left. I had to use escalation. The project progressed during my engagement: a test launch took place before I left.

[Read the case online](#)

Kickidler: From team diagnosis to delivery changes

Context and my work

At Kickidler, I diagnosed delivery, requirements and collaboration problems. I introduced a roadmap, used RACI and MoSCoW, and prepared an analyst template and a change plan.

Results

Based on my assessment, LTV increased by 20% and TTM halved. There were fewer bugs; analytics, motivation and team eNPS improved. Comparison periods and TTM/LTV methods are not provided here. These are team results, not the effect of one recommendation.

[Read the case online](#)

Further experience & skills

Statistics & Control: Turning complex systems into manageable work

Context

Worked in a four-person team on Honeywell DCS reverse engineering and scripts for equipment-version migrations. Later moved to OptiRamp, digital twins, forecasting and modelling for Russian and international clients. I managed projects with a combined value of approximately RUB 50 million per year. This describes project scale, not revenue attributed to my actions.

My role and actions

Coordinated the team and delivery; worked on requirements, risks and presales. Introduced Kanban, task evaluation, feedback and engineer onboarding processes. Prepared proposals for organisational transformation.

Consulting and analytical justification

In my 2022 HSE final project, developed an organisational transformation proposal: current and future reality trees, SWOT, a role model and pilot plan. Modelled costs, NPV and payback, and analysed schedule risks with Monte Carlo simulation in Primavera Risk Analysis. This is an assumption-based proposal and forecast, not verified savings.

[Read the case online](#)

Skills & tools

Product: product strategy, discovery, customer development, roadmap, prioritization, stakeholder management, Scrum/Kanban. Analytics and consulting: KPIs, LTV, business analysis, Current/Future Reality Trees, NPV. Team AI tools: n8n, LLM orchestration, hybrid RAG, PostgreSQL/PGVector. Practice: ClickHouse, Streamlit, ICONIX, PlantUML, SDD/OpenSpec, Git, Jira, Figma.

Python: basic. Russian: native. English: B2+/C1 (self-assessed).

Education & learning

Peter the Great St Petersburg Polytechnic University - Technical education, master's studies · 2009-2015

HSE · Master in Management - Professional education programme, with distinction · 2021-2022

PMP / Certified ScrumMaster - PMI / Scrum Alliance · 2023

Machine Learning / Deep Learning - SkillFactory · 2022